

Venla Parviainen

”HARMONY OF TECHNOLOGY, PEOPLE AND NATURE”

The discourses of smartness in audiovisual branding of the
Korean smart city

Faculty of Social Sciences
Bachelor's thesis
December 2022

ABSTRACT

Venla Parviainen: "Harmony of technology, people and nature" – The discourses of smartness in audiovisual branding of the Korean smart city

Bachelor's thesis

Tampere university

Degree Programme in Social Sciences

December 2022

The purpose of this study is to discover what kind of meanings are given to smartness in a Korean smart city branding video. Smart city is a multidimensional term that is given numerous different definitions depending on the emphasis of the researcher or project planner. In this research, smart city is understood as a contemporary urban development strategy, that aims at socio-economic, and sometimes environmental, improvements by incorporating information and communication technology into urban governance and urban planning. The meanings of smartness are examined by utilizing critical discourse studies, focusing not only on the meanings of smartness but also on the power relations within the discourses. Since the primary research material is an audiovisual video, in addition to critical discourse studies, iconographic analysis familiar from visual studies is applied to ensure a comprehensive analysis. Place branding serves as the theoretical framework for the research, accompanied by the concept of urban developmentalism, which provides background for the Korean context.

The chosen research material is a promotional video of the Busan Eco Delta Smart City, a project in South Korea, which presents a vision of what the future smart city will look like, what kind of services it provides, and what kind of people will live there. The video was published in 2019 on the official YouTube channel of the Korean Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, and Transport and is publicly viewable.

Based on the video, three discourses were created, each giving different kinds of meanings to smartness in the context of the smart city. These discourses were named as follows: smart comfort, smart development, and smart harmony. In the smart comfort discourse, smartness is understood as increased individual comfort. The second discourse, smart development, emphasizes the role of smartness as an advocate of economic growth and national development. The third discourse, smart harmony, understands smartness as creating order between the urban space and nature by utilizing technology. There exist different kinds of power relations within all of these discourses, which results in the exclusion of unfavorable actors, behaviors, and knowledge from discourse.

Based on the results, it can be concluded that the branding of the Busan Eco Delta Smart City project supports both the global place branding agenda and Korean urban developmentalism, which aims to shape the city into a manageable, productive, and aesthetic space. The goal is to strengthen the place's global brand, as well as to attract wealth and expertise to the city.

Keywords: place branding, smart city, urban developmentalism, Korea, critical discourse studies, critical visual analysis studies

The originality of this thesis has been checked using the Turnitin Originality Check service.

TIIVISTELMÄ

Venla Parviainen: "Teknologian, ihmisen ja luonnon harmonia" – Älykkyyden diskurssit korealaisen älykaupungin audiovisuaalisessa brändäyksessä
Kandidaatintutkielma
Tampereen yliopisto
Yhteiskuntatutkimuksen tutkinto-ohjelma
Joulukuu 2022

Tämän tutkimuksen tarkoituksena on selvittää, millaisia merkityksiä älykkyydelle annetaan korealaisen älykaupungin promootiovideossa. Älykaupunki on moniulotteinen käsite, jolle annetaan lukuisia erilaisia määritelmiä riippuen tutkijan tai projektisuunnittelijan painotuksesta. Tässä tutkimuksessa älykaupunki määritellään kaupunkikehitysstrategiana, jonka tavoitteena on sosiaalisten, taloudellisten, ja joissain tapauksissa ympäristöllisten, hyötyjen saavuttaminen omaksumalla tieto- ja viestintäteknologiaa osaksi kaupunkihallintoa. Älykkyyden merkityksiä tarkastellaan kriittisen diskurssitutkimuksen kautta keskittyen diskursseista löytyvien merkitysten lisäksi myös diskurssien sisällä vallitseviin valtasuhteisiin. Aineiston sisältäessä sekä ääntä että kuvia, sovelletaan tutkimuksessa kriittisen diskurssitutkimuksen lisäksi kriittisestä visuaalisesta metodologiasta tuttua ikonografista analyysia kokonaisvaltaisen analyysin varmistamiseksi. Paikan brändäys toimii tutkimuksen viitekehyksenä, jota täydennetään Korean kontekstia taustoittavalla urbaanin kehityskeskisyyden (eng. urban developmentalism) käsitteellä.

Tutkimusaineistona toimii korealaisen älykaupungin, Busan Eco Delta Smart Cityn, englanninkielinen promootiovideo, joka esittelee vision siitä, miltä älykaupunki tulee näyttämään, millaisia palveluita se tulee tarjoamaan ja millaisia ihmisiä siellä tulee asumaan. Video on julkaistu vuonna 2019 Korean maa-, infrastruktuuri- ja liikenneministeriön virallisella Youtube-kanavalla ja on vapaasti katsottavissa.

Aineistosta muodostettiin kolme diskurssia, jotka merkityksellistävät älykkyyttä älykaupungin kontekstissa erilaisin tavoin. Nämä diskurssit nimettiin seuraavasti: älykkyys mukavuutena, älykkyys kehityksenä sekä älykkyys harmoniana. Ensimmäisessä diskurssissa, älykkyys mukavuutena, älykkyys ymmärretään yksilön mukavuuden lisäämisenä. Toinen esiin noussut diskurssi, älykkyys kehityksenä, korostaa älykkyyden merkitystä talouskasvun ja kansallisen kehityksen edistäjänä. Kolmas diskurssi, älykkyys harmoniana, ymmärtää älykkyyden järjestyksen luomisena urbaanin tilan ja luonnon välillä hyödyntämällä teknologiaa. Kaikissa näissä diskursseissa esiintyy sisäisiä valtasuhteita, mikä johtaa epäsuotuisten toimijoiden, käyttäytymisen ja tiedon poissulkemiseen diskurssin ulkopuolelle.

Tulosten perusteella voidaan päätellä, että Busan Eco Delta Smart Cityn promootiovideo tukee sekä globaalia paikan brändäysagendaa että Korealle ominaista urbaania kehityskeskisyyttä, joiden pyrkimyksenä on muokata kaupunkia hallittavaksi, tuottavaksi ja esteettiseksi tilaksi. Tavoitteena on vahvistaa paikan globaalia brändiä, sekä houkutella vaurautta ja asiantuntijuutta kaupunkiin.

Avainsanat: paikan brändäys, älykäs kaupunki, urbaani kehityskeskisyys
Korea, kriittinen diskurssitutkimus, kriittinen visuaalinen tutkimus

Tämän julkaisun alkuperäisyys on tarkastettu Turnitin OriginalityCheck –ohjelmalla

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1 Introduction

“One of the things that makes ‘smart cities’ somewhat distinct from their cybernetic and intelligent forebears is that their every aspect is intensely visualized”
(Rose & Willis 2019, p.412)

Smart city has become a dominant, widely accepted global strategy impacting the urban development processes and future desires of cities' aesthetics and functions all around the world. The global smart city market value was estimated to be over 408 billion dollars in 2020, and it is expected to grow fast in the following years (Mustonen et al. 2014, 5). Growth is estimated to be especially fast in the Asian region, which hosts the fastest-growing urban population in the world. Due to the continuous growth of the urban population, there is an urgency to create the most innovative measures to keep providing housing and services for the growing needs of the present and future citizens. South Korea as an example hosts a large population of 51 million people with nearly half of them living in the capital city of Seoul. This has resulted in skyrocketing housing prices, increased housing inequalities, and severe environmental pollution. These increased urban problems are the key drivers of new towns and special zone projects, including newly developed smart cities, that focus on building new urban congestions on undeveloped land in the proximity of bigger urban metropolises (Doucette & Pak 2019).

What distinguishes the smart city from so-called traditional cities is that majority of the smart city projects are currently existing only as a visual vision of the future. This means, as Rose and Willis's (2019) quote above implies, that smart cities exist most importantly as representations of the urban future presented through verbal and visual branding materials. Due to the speculative nature of smart cities, the definition of smart in this context has remained unclear and subject to constant reconstruction depending on who and what kind of agenda is behind the definition (e.g., Vanolo 2014; Hollands 2008). In this thesis, a smart city is defined as an urban development strategy that aims at socio-economic, and sometimes environmental, improvements by incorporating information and communications technology (ICT) into urban governance and urban planning.

This thesis focuses on how meanings of smartness are constructed and visually presented in the smart city by examining a promotional video presenting a newly developed smart city, Busan Eco Delta Smart City, in South Korea (hereby Korea). Audio-visual materials in city branding are growing in popularity as tools to build a place brand and present aesthetically pleasing and positive visions of the urban future (Broudehoux 2017, xii). Though there is research on place branding through visual marketing materials in various fields like tourism, marketing, and political sciences, the focus of these studies is usually on “traditional” organic cities and not on artificial, yet-not-existing city models that many smart city projects are, including the Busan Eco-Delta Smart City. When it comes to research on smart cities, most of it is either technology-focused (e.g., Markova et al. 2017), governance-focused (e.g., Caragliu & Del 2019), or focused on the relationship between citizens’ rights and surveillance. (e.g., Cardullo et al. 2019). There isn’t much critical social scientific research on smart city branding, though social sciences have a lot to offer to urban research for example when exploring how current urban structures are created and how they impact the well-being of communities and the environment. This research aims at exploring this less-researched aspect of the meaning of smartness in smart city branding by utilizing concepts of place branding and urban developmentalism with methods from critical discourse studies and critical visual studies.

The study is structured as follows: Chapter two explores Korea’s contemporary urban history with a focus on Korean urban development processes and the emergence of the smart city strategy. The purpose is to understand how Korean modernization and urbanization processes have been shaped over the history and what kind of agendas were driving these processes. In addition, the second chapter introduces the Busan Eco Delta Smart City project, the case of a Korean smart city examined in this thesis. The third chapter is dedicated to defining three key concepts relevant to the research topic: place branding, smart city, and urban developmentalism. After laying the foundation by exploring the background and key concepts related to the topic, the fourth chapter moves into introducing the research methodology of this thesis. The research methodology includes explaining the reasoning behind forming the research questions, describing the branding video chosen as the research material, outlining critical discourse studies and critical visual studies as the research methods, and finally discussing ethical considerations that were taken throughout the research process. The

fifth chapter is dedicated to unwrapping all the phases of the analysis, focusing on the three main discourses of smartness that were derived from the research material. The final chapter is dedicated to summarizing the main results of the thesis and discussing the implications of these results from a broader perspective of both Korean urban development as well as global smart city branding. The final chapter also reflects on the limitations and strengths of the methods and materials used in this thesis, followed by suggestions for future research.

2 Background of the thesis

This chapter begins by describing the historical experiences and ideologies that shaped Korea's development processes throughout the 20th and 21st centuries. The exploration begins from the Japanese colonialization period of the early 20th, continuing to the Cold War situation and the emerging developmentalism, and finally ends at the present era of smart cities. After discussing the history of Korean development processes, the focus is directed toward a specific smart city project that is analyzed in this thesis: The Busan Eco Delta Smart City Project. The purpose of the second chapter is to provide an overview of the historical and contemporary development processes that continue to impact the way development is viewed and practiced in Korean urban spaces.

2.1 Brief history of Korean urban development

Japanese colonialization period (1910-1945) had a major impact on the modernization of Korea, especially regarding its economy and infrastructure. The development processes started by the Japanese forces were however unbalanced and incoherent, impacting Korea's development processes even long after Korea was released from Japanese rule. (Kim 2006, p.103.) According to Eckert (2014), the colonial government was heavily focused on economic development and creating the native capitalist class. This economically inclined legacy impacted the post-colonial developmentalist state policies that characterized the development path of Korea throughout the Cold War era (1947-1991) (Eckert 2014, p. 255). Though the legacy of Japan's developmentalist model continued to influence especially the economic policies of Korea, the United States' influence grew over Korea during and after the Korean War

(1950-1953) which resulted in adapting some liberalist aspects to the state-led model (Kim 2006, p.106). This is when the developmentalist state model in Korea emerged.

Developmentalism refers to economy-focused state-led authoritarian development considered to be present, particularly in “developing” countries' state-making processes. The developmentalist mindset emphasizes techno-industrial development intending to achieve the desired image of a modern nation in the global struggle between states for economic and diplomatic power (Thurbon 2016, 2). Developmentalism is connected to Korea's desire for modernity. After the Korean War, Korea set up the goal of fast modernization that could be achieved through economic and industrial development. This development was legitimated by emphasizing the pressing need to catch up with the west, and the inevitable nature of modernization. (Kim 2006, 103.) The authoritarian government of the Cold-War years succeeded in creating the so-called economic miracle, which legitimized the continuation of authoritarian governance in Korea's economic, societal, and urban development.

The developmentalist state model has shaped Korean society in all its aspects, most certainly including urban spaces and urban development processes. Developmentalist policies applied to urban processes, urban developmentalism, enabled rapid economic growth, especially in the technology industry, the rise of middle classes, and the growth of cities. However, this development was achieved without taking into consideration the negative impacts it had, like regionally uneven development, environmental devastation, and rising social inequalities (Kim 2006, 110). In an attempt to solve these emerging issues, technological innovations began to be incorporated into the management of urban spaces.

Using technology to advance urban life is not a novel idea. Vision and utopias of a city that uses a range of technologies have been visioned since the early 20th century (Angelidou 2015, 96). The emergence of the term “smart” in the urban context however traces back to the large-scale development of everyday life technologies starting from the late 1980s. The final push to the smart city trend was the arrival of big IT companies and their extensive promotion of new smart technologies in the late 1990s. This process took place in the United States and Europe. When and how did smart cities spread to Asia, specifically to Korea? Though technology was slowly in-

incorporated into Korean city planning since the 1990s, The Korean government adopted the concept of Ubiquitous cities (U-cities) in their official policy program and law system first time in 2008. In 2017, The Korean government changed ubiquitous to smart in order to make the concept more comprehensible to the general public. (Smart City Korea.) Now in 2022, nearly every Korean city has its own smart city plans, and there have been multiple new smart city projects funded by national and municipal governments together with technological companies. Two major smart city projects with national funding are under process right now: Busan Eco Delta Smart City and Sejong 5-1 Living Area. Now the focus will turn to the former project.

2.2 The Busan Eco Delta Smart City

"We make a city

And the city re-makes Us"

(Busan Eco Delta Smart City plan 2018,)

Busan Eco Delta Smart city is an urban development project done in collaboration with the Korean government, The City of Busan, K-water, and Busan Metropolitan Corporation. The city will be in Gangseo-gu, an area part of the city of Busan, 15 kilometers away from the city center and the harbor, and 5 kilometers away from Gimhae International Airport. The project consists of the whole of Busan Eco Delta City which includes the national pilot smart city project, which takes about 1/6th of the planned area and population (image 1). The national pilot smart city works as a living lab for incorporating and testing out new technological innovations that are hoped to improve residential, commercial, and governmental functions. Though this distinction between the national smart city pilot project and Busan Eco Delta City is made, in the branding materials the whole area is referred to as a smart city.

Busan Eco Delta City (EDC)

Location	around Gangseo-gu, Busan
Area	11.8km ²
Schedule	2012~2023
Target Population	76,000 people (30,000 households)
Focus	Housing, commerce, R&D, logistics, etc.
Developers	Busan Metropolitan City, K-water, Busan Metropolitan Corporation

National Smart City Pilot Project

Area	2.8km ²
Target Population	8,500 people (3,380 households)
Advantages	Multi-functioning area including major city features, such as housing, commercial and R&D ideal for application of cutting-edge technologies

Image 1. Screenshot from the official website of Busan (Overview of EDSM). Available at: <https://www.busan.go.kr/eng/ecodelta01>

In the Busan Smart Eco Delta City Plan (2018) found on the Smart City Korea website, the pursued direction of the Korean smart city and the ways of getting there through BEDSC (Busan Eco Delta Smart City) are explained. The goal of adopting the smart city approach is to find solutions to the urban problems that Korean cities face, the most serious ones being flooding, traffic jams, air pollution, and other environmental pollution (Busan Smart Eco Delta City Plan 2018, p.8). The report explains that by solving these problems, the end goal is to improve the quality of life and happiness of Koreans, who have ranked rather low in global happiness reports (e.g., 59th in 2022 UN Happiness report).



Image 2. A vision of Busan Eco Delta Smart City (Busan Smart Eco Delta City plan 2018, p. 18)

Busan Eco Delta Smart City takes inspiration from both European and North American as well as Asian smart city models, which both have quite different approaches to smart cities. According to the Busan Smart Eco Delta City plan (2018), combining the approach focusing on improving the quality of life through active citizen participation (European and North American model) with the approach emphasizing the development of urban and industrial infrastructure based on the newest fourth industrial revolution technology (Asian model), a completely new smart city model can be created. This translates to the vision of a smart city which is branded as a city in harmony with major technologies of the fourth industrial revolution and the ecological environment centered on three rivers. (Ibid., 16-18.) The harmony between technology and nature can be identified from the imagery presented in the plan. The bird-eye view of the city shows a cityscape featuring futuristic skyscrapers combined with traditional-looking low-rise buildings that are surrounded by greenery and water (image 2).

3 Theoretical framework

3.1 Place branding as a social construct

The roots of place branding are in the idea that places can be managed, developed, and marketed similarly as products and services are promoted (Kavaratzis et al. 2018,1). As place branding was initially used for promoting tourism, the idea that tourists choose their travel destination based on the place's positive attributes, similarly as consumers choose products, become a popular and widely accepted assumption (Coshall 2000). This assumption has been criticized by emphasizing the unique nature of places as spaces that are dynamic, diverse, and lack a unified goal, making it problematic to treat places similarly as businesses or products. In order to apply the idea of branding to places, the large number of stakeholders, the contradicting goals of these stakeholders, and the varied lived experiences should be recognized as forces that complicate the branding process. (Broudehox 2017, xiv-xxi.) Porter (2016) provides an alternative to the traditional view by defining place branding in the following manner:

“It is a pervasive, strategic tool used to establish and manage the meaningful sets relations between things, people, images, texts and physical environments, typically with a view to increasing their market appeal” (Porter 2016, 232,233).

This definition differs from the traditional view by emphasizing the persuasive and strategic nature of place branding. Place branding utilizes various visual and verbal communication strategies to effectively build a place brand that is memorable, coherent, and marketable. According to Porter (2016), this is done for example by emphasizing the uniqueness of place; by reinforcing key images and values associated with the brand; and by simplifying messages used in branding materials (Porter 2016, 233). These strategies however create a risk of producing over-simplified place identities that are based on stereotypes rather than actual characteristics of a place. In addition, branding strategies are selective when choosing which characteristics of a place are included in its brand building. (Ibid., 233-244.) Therefore, it is arguable if place branding reflects the place that is promoting or is it representing a desired and imagined identity of that place.

Another way that Porter’s (2016) definition of place branding differs from the traditional view is that the goal of place branding to increase the place’s market appeal is brought forth. Place branding is inherently based on the idea that places can be ranked from good to bad, and competition between places is a natural and desirable act that all places should participate in. A place cannot survive in the competitive global system if it does not manage to create an attractive brand for itself. Doucette and Pak (2019) refer to this phenomenon as “place war” that is connected to the globalization of neo-liberal urban policies as the natural and inevitable direction for all places that want to maintain their place in the global community (Doucette & Pak 2019, 316-317).

3.2 Smart City as a strategy

The most well-known definition of a smart city is the six-piece model created by Griffinder et al (2007). According to this model, a smart city needs to consider aspects of smart economy, smart people, smart governance, smart mobility, smart environment, and smart living. To summarize the factors that describe these six characteristics: A smart city is an economically competitive city that invests in social capital,

practices transparent and participatory governance, offers accessible and sustainable transport and ICT systems, contributes to environmental protection, and aims at improving the quality of people's lives. (Griffinder et al. 2007, 11-12.) Therefore, though many of the smart city projects seen around the world have roots leading back to this model, each project chooses to embrace certain parts over others and reshape the characteristics to fit the agenda being pursued. This point is elaborated next by explaining how smart cities can be understood as strategies that have a strongly discursive nature.

In this research, a smart city is understood as a contemporary urban development *strategy*, that aims at socio-economic, and sometimes environmental, improvements by incorporating ICT into urban governance and urban planning. Fairclough (2013) defines strategies as an attempt to fix or transform the existing failing structures present in society (Fairclough 2013, 14). Strategies can either focus on mitigating immediate effects or on long-term repair and restructuring. Usually, in the case of smart cities, they are visioned as long-term strategies, that will solve the current urban problems and guarantee better living conditions for many future generations to come. This is where the discursive nature of strategies becomes prominent. (Fairclough 2013, 18-19.) In the context of urban development, strategies represent certain kinds of ideologies about the future, and they reproduce certain legitimized ways of knowing and doing. The nature of the smart city strategy changes depending on whether it is a local or national project; if it is already existing or a newly planned city; if it invests in hard or soft infrastructure; and if it is an economic sector-based or geographically based project. (Angelidou 2014.)

The neutral and often critical academic definitions of the smart city may differ from the smart city definition given in the branding materials, which usually employ positive and persuasive language and imagery. According to the Smart City Korea brochure, a smart city is defined as

“A platform to improve the quality of life for citizens, enhance the sustainability of cities, and foster new industries by utilizing innovative technologies of the 4th Industrial Era” (Smart City Korea brochure, 4).

As was noted earlier when looking at BEDSC Planning document, the project combines aspects from European and North American smart cities with Asian smart cities to form a hybrid smart city that pursues to combine citizens' well-being, environmental sustainability, and technological development. When looking at the Smart City Korea brochure's definitions of a smart city, it seems that BEDSC aligns with the national definition of a smart city. Comparing this definition created by the planners with the academic definition of a smart city, the difference is apparent especially in the tone of the text as well as in the word choices. The definition found in the planning document uses phrases, such as "enhance sustainability" and "innovative technologies", that emphasize the positive and attractive attributes of the smart city. The language is persuasive, compared to the neutral or critical tone of academic definitions. This definition is created in order to drive Korea's national smart city agenda which is framed by urban developmentalist legacies.

3.3 Urban Developmentalism

Urban developmentalism examines how developmentalist policies are used in urban spaces (Doucette & Pak 2019, 2). Developmentalist policies refer to economically driven state-led policies, that are based on the assumption that modernization is inevitable and desirable end-goal to all countries. Compared to studies focusing solely on developmentalism on a national level, by using the concept of urban developmentalism, the city and urban areas can be connected to the national development plans. One important argument of urban developmentalism is that cities should not be put out of their historical context or considered autonomous and territorially coherent areas, though this is exactly what characterizes the East Asian urbanization process of spatial selectivity in the forms of special zones (Doucette & Pak 2019). Doucette and Pak (2019) argue that developmentalist cities are not actually cities in their usual definition, but rather live alongside or within different forms of urban governance (Ibid., 4).

As become prevalent, when looking at the history of Korean urban development, the legacy of developmentalism affects the urbanization processes happening in East Asia even after the end of the Cold War Era (Doucette & Pak 2019, 1). East Asian region is the place where the idea of the developmental state was originally formed (Dent 2018, 1191). The Cold War era in Korea has been called the period of national

developmentalism, characterized by authoritarian governments and rapid industrial development. During the post-Cold War era, developmentalism transformed itself to fit the neoliberal, speculative and spatially selective forms of urban discourses that become dominant in East Asia (Doucette and Pak 2019, 4) From 1960s onwards Korean urban development was characterized by heavy industrialization and dense construction of housing. Later the identity of urban spaces was rebranded by methods such as place promotion, beautification, and mega-event promotion that were supported by the national and subnational governments that worked closely with the private sector. (Ibid., 249.) Smart city strategy can be understood as one method of reforming the identity of the Korean urban space by following the developmentalist policies of speculation and order.

4 Methodology

The main research question of this thesis is *What kind of meanings are given to the concept of 'smart' in Busan Eco-Delta smart city's audiovisual branding?* This question is accompanied by a question of *how these meanings create inclusion or exclusion of certain types of actors, behavior, and knowledge within discourses.* The main research question focuses on identifying the different discourses and describing them whereas the accompanied question explores how these discourses produce and reinforce certain types of truths and subject positions prevalent in a larger societal context.

The purpose of this research is to explore how the concept of smartness is used in audiovisual place branding, specifically in branding smart cities. The focus is on constructing different meanings that the idea of 'smartness' is given in the Busan Eco Delta Smart City's promotional video. Through this examination, the goal is to find out if certain types of knowledge and subject positions are considered more legitimate and powerful while other ways of knowing and being are excluded. By exploring the discourses and the power struggles within them, it is possible to understand how smartness is made meaningful, what kind of regimes of truth smart city is associated with, and what forms of social exclusion are prevalent in the smart city discourses.

4.1 Research material

Since this thesis studies smartness in the context of audiovisual place branding, a promotional video was chosen as the primary research material. The video is titled “What if the city starts thinking? [Busan Ecto Delta SMART CITY]”¹ and was published on Korea’s Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, and Transport (국토교통부) official YouTube channel on 25th of November 2019. The video is 4 minutes and 35 seconds long and includes videography, photography, animation, text, graphs, music, and a human voice. Though the video is narrated in English, some of the text, graphs, and lines remain un-translated from the original Korean version. The target audience of the video is not clearly defined, but by observing the video, it seems that the main audience is the potential future residents of the city. The video could also target foreign urban planners, researchers, and investors who could be interested in contributing to making the vision of BEDSM happen. This video was chosen as the primary research material of this thesis because it was produced and published by a recognized and powerful stakeholder in Korean urban planning. The video is also relatively new and has gathered over 35 thousand views, meaning that the branding has reached a large audience.

When looking at Busan Eco-Delta Smart City’s audiovisual marketing targeted toward the Korean audience, there is variety in the formats and channels through which these materials are published, including Instagram and YouTube channels of various stakeholders. In contrast, English material is limited to a few videos and official presentation slides found on a Governmental website. The lack of official audiovisual marketing materials and the existence of various stakeholders and platforms where the audiovisual marketing takes place makes it challenging to know the official brand image of Busan Eco-Delta Smart City. Then again, the large number of stakeholders indicates that the project is not implemented just by one actor enforcing one type of narrative that may not serve the majority of those to whom the project may concern. It can also be a way to neutralize the claims of truth as they cannot be traced back to certain local institutions but seem to be part of an ambiguous global movement promoting smart cities.

¹ The English title has two typos: thinking (correct: thinking) and Ecto (correct: Eco).

4.2 Research methods

This research investigates how a strategy currently dominating urban development (*smart city*) is translated and reproduced through different semiotic dimensions (*text, film, sound, speech*) used in place branding materials. This is done by combining critical discourse, specifically power analysis, with elements of visual analysis, specifically iconographic analysis.

4.2.1 Critical discourse analysis

Critical discourse analysis (CDA) is a critical social research method that examines how power relations are created through language. Accredited researchers in discourse studies (for example Wodak and Mayer 2001; Dijk 2015) agree that CDA is not a school of discourse analysis but rather a critical approach to studying language through various social science research methods that suit the purpose of a study (Dijk 2015, 466). With this understanding of the CDA, I chose to combine power analysis, a form of discourse analysis focused on the power relations created within discourses, with elements of visual analysis, specifically iconography. These methods allow the critical examination of how meanings of smartness are constructed in written, spoken, and visual dimensions.

Fairclough (2013) understands critical discourse analysis as a moderate form of social constructivism where the world is thought to consist of various socially constructed representations (Fairclough 2013, 5). Representation refers, in this context, to different ways a phenomenon is described or considered. Certain representations become more dominant than others, eventually becoming naturalized norms. These representations are both created through and contribute to the creation of socially circulating discourse. (Ibid., 34, 36.) Discourses are groups of statements that construct a certain type of understanding of a phenomenon or concept, for example, smartness (Rose 2002, 136). However, not all discourses have the same effect on how reality is built. Which representations ultimately shape social reality in a certain direction depends on the conditions in which these representations are produced. This is where *regimes of truth* become relevant. Foucault understands that there exists an order of discourses that forms “regimes of truth” within societies, reflecting the ideologies and valuation of certain types of knowledge over others. (Foucault 1980,

131.) With the understanding that knowledge is intricately connected to power, the dominance of certain discourses can be explained not only by the support they receive from socially powerful institutions, but also by the way they make claims of truth (Rose 2002, 138). These claims of truth are what power analysis is interested in. Jokinen et al (2016) introduce five different aspects² of focus that power analysis can be used to examine. In this research, the focus is on *the power relations within discourses*. When focusing on the power relations within discourse, the interest is in what is allowed to be talked about and in what way; what kind of relationships different actors have within a discourse; and what kind of subject positions are people or things placed. (Jokinen et al. 2016, 75, 85-86.) The analysis of power relations aligns with the interest of critical discourse analysis since it allows the critical examination of the relationship between language and power, and of what kind of social inclusion and exclusion discourses can produce.

CDA has been sometimes criticized for making moral statements and relying on reflexive views of the truth when evaluating the power relations between and within discourses. According to Wodak and Meyer (2001, 65) however, the purpose when conducting critical discourse analysis is not to evaluate what discourse is “right” and what is “wrong”. Blommaert (2005) shares similar views with Wodak and Meyer by stating that instead of considering CDA as a method that works against power, it should be viewed as an attempt to understand power, how it is formed and how it impacts society (Blommaert 2005, 2). Therefore, the goal is to examine how discourses make claims of the truth and through these claims of the truth, how discourses construct the world (Le & Short 2009, 82). However, what makes CDA distinct from other forms of discourse studies is its intention to create change in the world. Fairclough (2013) suggests that instead of only pointing out the problems of the current *structures*, a new type of CDA focused on the positive critique of new *strategies* can be applied to create possibilities for transformations that can mitigate negative social impacts. This shift from analyzing structures to analyzing strategies is particularly relevant during times of crisis where different strategies are created to replace or solve the failures of existing structures. (Fairclough 2013, 14,18.) This research utilizes this

² 1) the power relations between discourses; 2) the power relations within discourses; 3) the hegemonization of discourses; 4) The ideological implications of discourses; and 5) the questioning of hegemonic discourses (Jokinen et al. 2016, 75.)

new understanding of CDA as an exploration and contribution for change by examining the newly emerging urban development strategy of smart cities.

4.2.2 Iconographic analysis in critical visual methodology

In this research, visual analysis is understood as an umbrella term for various types of research done to examine visual materials like photographs, videos, art pieces, magazines, and advertisements to give a few examples. As Rose (2002, 6) states that “visual is central to the cultural construction of social life in contemporary (Western) societies”. Images are not transparent windows to the world or a way to discover the truth about something, but rather they interpret the world, and therefore the analysis of images is also an interpretation. This does not mean however that visual analysis is pure speculation without evidence; interpretation needs to be justified by laying bare all the steps taken during the analysis. The visual analysis used in this research follows three key principles of critical visual methodology. Firstly, images need be understood as powerful in their own right, not merely as reflections of their social contexts. Secondly, images do not only reflect social reality but also produce it, both in constructive and destructive ways. Lastly, images are interpreted always from a certain context. Therefore, the researcher’s way of seeing is also tied to a certain context, meaning it is not any more neutral or innocent than other ways of seeing. (Ibid., 15.)

Visual analysis pairs well with critical discourse analysis as both emphasize the historical and cultural context when conducting the analysis, and both focus on analyzing the meaning of the material rather than its concrete form (Rose 2001, 144). In this study a specific method of visual studies, iconographic analysis, is used alongside the critical discourse studies, specifically alongside power analysis, to enable the analysis of all aspects of the material. The iconographic analysis follows a similar pattern to CDA as it starts with a description (pre-iconographic phase), followed by an interpretation (iconographic phase) and explanation (iconological). The descriptive part of the analysis begins in this study by utilizing the pre-iconographic phase, followed by clustering of the main visual, textual, and verbal themes present in the video. The interpretation and explanation phases are combined in the sections that introduce the discourses present in the video. That section discusses the discourses

both from the aspect what kind of meanings the described imagery and speech create about smartness, and also what type of people, behaviors and knowledge is included or excluded from this view of smartness.

4.3 Ethical considerations

This study follows the code of conduct set for research integrity set out by All European Academies (ALLEA). In the European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity (2017) four ground principles of well-done research are introduced. These principles are *reliability* in ensuring the quality of results; *honesty* when conducting and reporting the research; *respect* towards colleges and societal, cultural, or environmental institutions that the research may concern; and *accountability* concerning publication and management of the research. (ALLEA 2017, 4.)

Certain ethical implications need to be considered specifically when using critical discourse analysis as a research method. In critical social science research, the researcher is understood as a meaning-maker. Therefore, the researcher is never able to analyze the subject with complete neutrality. For this reason, the researcher must declare their own or the research material's ideological orientations if they intrude on the analysis (Le & Short 2009, 97). The moralization and the view of reflexive truths that CDA is being criticized is something that the researcher needs to consider and attempt to prevent when performing the analysis.

5 The discourses of smartness in Busan's smart city vision

5.1 Pre-discourse analysis

The first phase of the analysis is about putting into words the surface-level observations that one can notice by looking at the facts; what kind of imagery, sounds, and text is presented in the video. In iconographic analysis, this phase is called the primary or pre-iconographic phase. This phase is not unique only to iconographic analysis but applies to any kind of visual analysis since it is crucial to form an overall picture of the research material before looking at the meanings these "facts" convey. (Rose 2002, 144.)

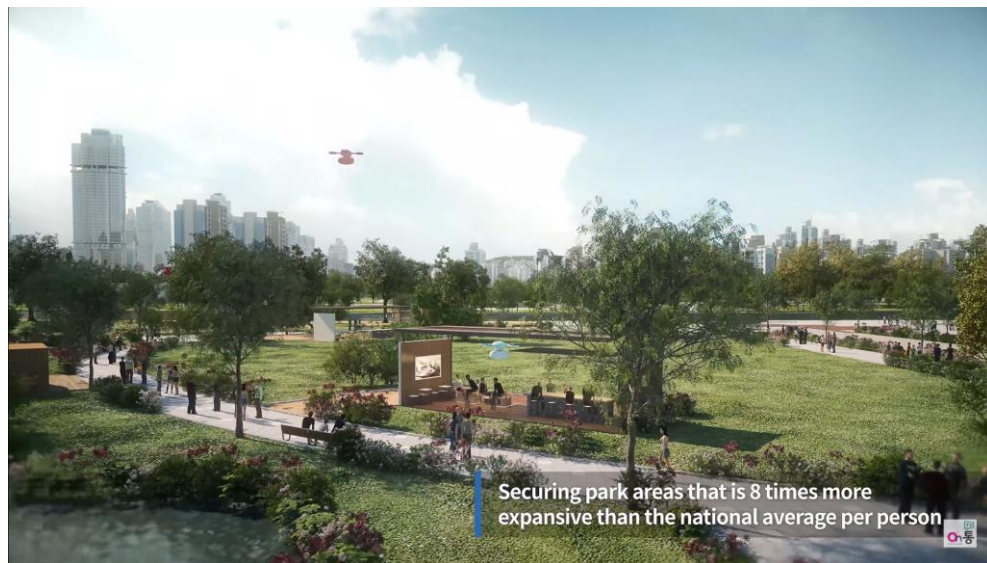


Image 3. The visual landscape

When looking at the video's visual aspects as a whole, the visual imagery focuses on presenting the city's architecture, infrastructure, and various services that the city has to offer. The visual imagery is colorful throughout the video, with an emphasis on green, blue and white, which can be seen, for example, in the coloring of buildings, technology, and green areas. The elements that appear most often or are emphasized throughout the video are buildings, cars, robots, technological screens, green areas, and water (Image 3). The shots also include people, the majority of them appearing as ethnically Korean, well-bodied, and in their 30s. Few shots include children, the elderly, non-Koreans, or disabled people. The most frequent actions include walking, running, and discussing in a group either outdoors on the street and in parks, or in work or school-type indoor settings.

The video has a lot of editing, special effects, and different transitions from one shot to another. The filming angles shift between bird-eye view, street view, and zooming effect as well as speeding up and slowing down the shot. The video also mixes animation and filmed material together. Some of the filmed material seem to be filmed for the purpose of this video while others are taken from external sources.

The video's audio consists of a human voice that narrates the video while music plays on the background. A narrator seems to be a middle-aged man with an Ameri-

can accent and his tone is enthusiastic and strong. The background music changes four times, but the music remains fast-paced, cheery, and powerful throughout the video. The people do not speak or make any voices throughout the video, except when a female actor says one line in Korean as she commands “Delta, play some cheerful music”.

5.2 Clustering

After the pre-iconographic description, the video is deconstructed by clustering reoccurring visual and verbal key themes into meaningful groups (Rose 2001,150). The clusters formed based on the key themes were futurism, economic prosperity, ecology, community, and convenience which are presented in the chart below.

Clusters					
themes	<i>futurism</i>	<i>economic prosperity</i>	<i>ecology</i>	<i>community</i>	<i>convenience</i>
visual	color blue	workplaces and schools	color green	people in groups	electrics replacing paper
	screens	sky scrapers	proximity of water	buzzing streets	clean drinking water
verbal	"ultra-realistic technology"	"sustainable growth of companies and countries"	"eco-friendly"	"human-centric"	"better-to-live in"
	"4th industrial revolution"	"business opportunities"	"co-existence with nature"	"our city"	"balance between work and leisure"
visual and verbal	robot-friendly infrastructure	creativity	green spaces	cultural events	easy mobility
	futuristic city	connecting innovative ideas	renewable energy	accessible spaces	easy services (shopping, delivery)

Chart. Clusters of reoccurring visual and verbal imagery

This phase enabled observing the video more in detail, and to categorize details into meaningful clusters. In the next phase, three discourses were formed based on these clusters. The theme of convenience was combined with aspects of the theme of community to form the discourse of smart comfort. Economic prosperity with features

of futurism formed the discourse of smart nation. And finally, the third discourse, smart harmony, was formed by combining the themes of ecology with themes of community. Next, these discourses will be discussed by examining what kind of audiovisual and verbal meanings of smartness each one conveys.

5.3 Discourse of smart comfort

The discourse of smart comfort conceptualizes smartness as something that enables individuals to live more comfortably and enjoy their everyday lives by utilizing smart innovations that make their daily lives easier. These smart innovations refer to technological advancements like weather predicting software, clean tap water, AI-based shopping apps, electrical documents, and delivery robots. These innovations are visually presented by showing people using these services with facial expressions showing satisfaction and happiness (image 3). The life-changing nature of these innovations is reinforced by narrators' phrases such as "Urban innovations will change people's lives and add value" and "Robots will be used across various fields, so we experience a far smarter life".

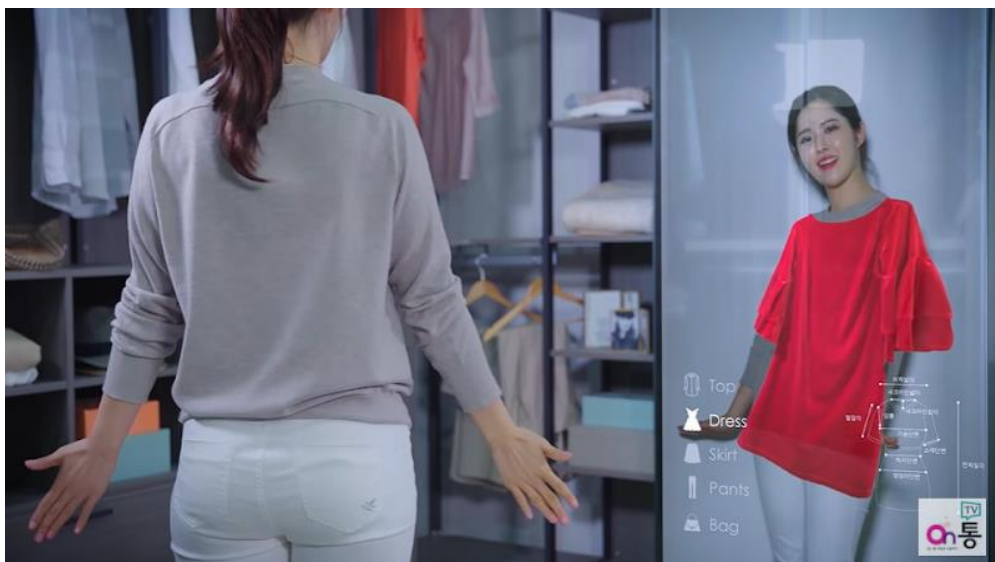


Image 4. AI shopping mirror enables shopping from home

Another way smartness as comfort and convenience is represented is the statement of increased free time. In the introduction part of the video, the narrator states that "With an emphasis on convenience rather than economy, we will realize the balance between work and leisure." The way this balance is being realized is by "creating ac-

cessible green spaces throughout the city". The increased leisure time is not mentioned directly after this statement, but it is implied by people's actions. People are shown enjoying cultural street festivals, spending time together in parks and cafes, and exercising outdoors. In addition, the decreased use of time in mundane activities such as daily commuting time, shopping (Image 4), and ordering food by using technological innovation implies that smartness means saving time.

The relationships of different actors, here including potential residents, the institution creating the city, and technology, are based on services. The benefiter of these services is the individual resident, whereas the city and technology are placed in the role of service providers. Life in the smart city is depicted to be full of opportunities (more free time, more personal space, more activities) and with fewer responsibilities (less work, less house maintenance, less commuting) for the individual. This discourse depicts the smart city as a "human-centric city", where technology serves individuals and increases their quality of life. Therefore, potential residents are put in the most powerful subject position in this discourse.

Although individuals are depicted as the greatest benefiter of smartness, this subject position is still imposed not by the subject themselves but by authorities who have certain assumptions of individuals and their desires. Within this discourse, individuals are assumed to be rather as passive consumers than active citizens, who are more interested in making their lives comfortable and less interested in the responsibilities they have towards society. Therefore, the comfort and convenience that smartness can bring are emphasized instead of emphasizing for example the increased possibilities for citizen participation that smart technology can provide. Looking at the relationships of actors from this perspective, it is not so obvious anymore that individuals are the greatest beneficiaries of this discourse. In fact, this discourse may reinforce the developmentalist legacy of top-down planning which understands citizen participation as a service relationship where individuals are allowed to enjoy the spaces and services provided for them in exchange for their feedback or data using on using these services.

In addition to limiting the certain type of subject position individuals can hold in the smart city, also the type of people who are allowed to participate in the discourse is

limited. The language and imagery of the video imply that the desired resident is a healthy, wealthy, and creative young adult who is looking for and can afford to live in spacious apartments further from the buzzing and disoriented city center. There is some imagery of children and families, but they are not directly mentioned by the narrator. One aspect that could be targeted towards children is the short mention of smart education in written form while an image of a class setting with tablets as note-taking materials is shown in the background. This is followed by the narrator's phrase "creativity will spread across the nation and will benefit society". This phrase emphasizes that society benefits from smart education, not necessarily individuals, especially children. Another group that is not considered in this discourse is those working in non-creative fields, especially in the service sector. The comfort of smart technology is closely related to the robotization of service sector jobs like logistics, transportation, retail, and restaurant industries. Smart comfort relies in this context on the exclusion of certain professions, restricting entry to the discourse only to those whose work will not be replaceable by smart technology.

5.4 Discourse of smart development

In this discourse smart represents something new, revolutionary, and global. Smart innovations are described to reinforce economic growth and global competition, therefore contributing to the positive development of Korean businesses and the nation.

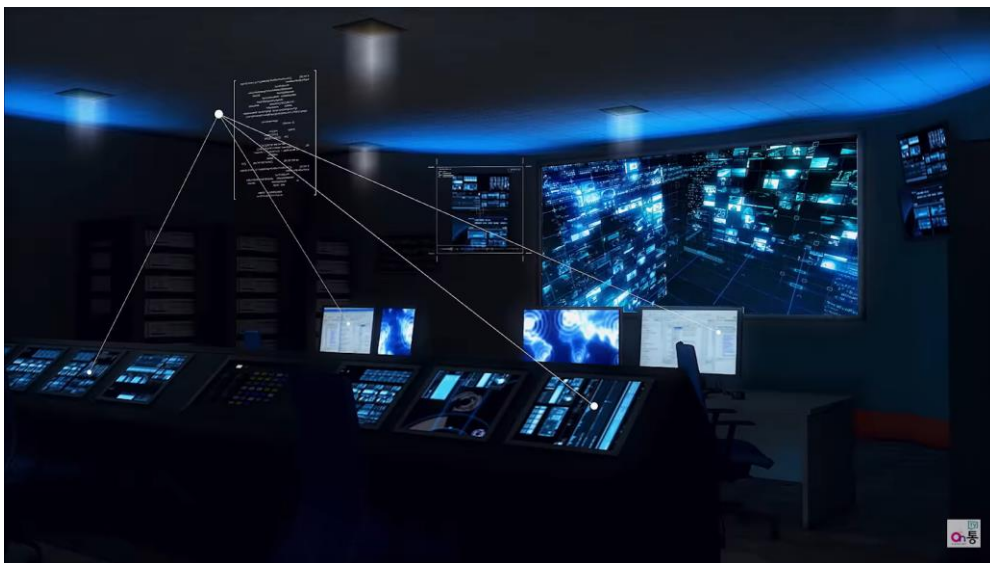


Image 5. Blue electric screens

The meaning of smartness as something new and revolutionary is emphasized through the use of abstract imagery in the forms of animated graphs, geometric figures, and electronic screens connected by a string of blue light (image 5). These images convey the idea that smart is something so new that it does not yet exist in the real world and therefore needs to be shown through man-made models that are not easy to understand for the average observer. Smartness is also described by using ubiquitous and technical terms like “ultra-realistic technology” and “robot-friendly infrastructure”. The revolutionizing nature of the smart city project is emphasized by narrators’ phrases such as “this life that no one has experienced before...” and “...we can lead the 4th industrial revolution era.” The latter phrase emphasizes smartness as a national development project that “we” are executing together.

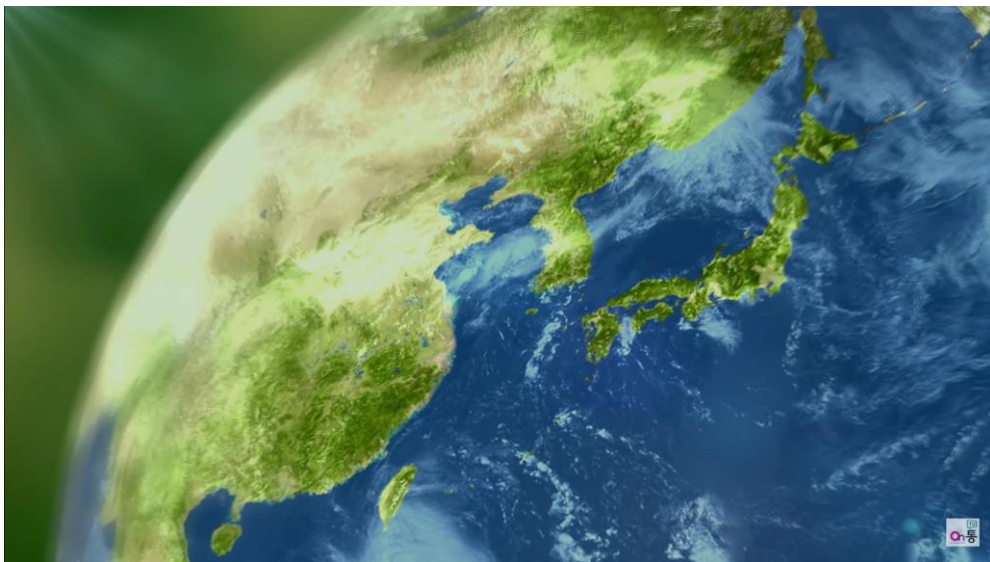


Image 6. The space view of Korea

The relationship between actors is quite different compared to the smart comfort discourse, which emphasizes individuality and the local impacts of technology. Smart nation discourse understands the relationship between the nation, its citizens, and technology to be crucial in achieving smartness. The nation as a global actor constructs smartness through technology, and citizens of the country are working together to enforce national development and competitiveness in this field. Smartness connects to being global by using large, bird-eye view shots that focus on buzzing cities or even the whole globe (image 6) instead of people. Video also uses a zooming

effect, where the first shot starts from afar and slowly zooms in closer. These findings indicate that ideas start from up - from the global, national, or expert context - and not from down - from the people in the local context. The global nature of the project is also visible through the choice of naming the project only in English and making an English promotional video targeting the international audience.

Considering the inclusion and exclusion of certain types of people, behavior, and knowledge, this discourse excludes the ordinary individual by using expert language and technical terms. The meaning of smartness is outside the grasp of the individual, and it should be left to the concern of powerful global actors like nations and big corporations. Competition between nations is considered a natural behavior, creating an expectation that the whole nation shares and pursues the same goals to succeed in the global arena.

5.5 Discourse of smart harmony

In this discourse smart means balance and peaceful existence between the urban and natural environments. Compared to the previous discourse on growth where smart represented something completely new and revolutionary, here smart means something based in the natural world, exemplified by the following phrase: “If someone asks about the evolution and origins of cities, we turn to water for the answer”. This phrase is said while simultaneously image of water on a green leaf transitions to an image of the globe zooming into the Korean peninsula. However, while the previous phrase presents the relationship between urban communities and nature as something fundamental and evolutionary, contradictory language is used when talking about the coexistence between humans and nature. This coexistence represents something new that needs to be *created* as the following phrase implies: “We are creating a new space where nature and humans coexist”.



Image 7. The visualization of accessible green spaces

In this discourse, the key actors are the urban community, nature, and technology. Smartness is described as the harmonical living of these three actors as the ending statement of the video explains: “A waterfront which makes in a harmony of technology, people and nature”. What is meant by harmony or coexistence is not clearly defined, but it is implied that harmony between people and nature will be achieved by “creating accessible green spaces throughout the city”. However, the visual imagery shown simultaneously while saying this phrase depicts a street view with shops, concrete roads, and a few trees along the sidewalk (image 7). Is this what is meant by accessible green spaces? The relationship between technology and nature is most visible when referring to technological innovation that will improve water management systems, utilize renewable energy, and prevent natural disasters. The relationship between technology and nature seems to be technical, focused on managing and using natural resources efficiently and sustainably, whereas the relationship between nature and people emphasizes the intrinsic value of having nature in the city and having easy access to nature. However, all of these relationships assume that nature is initially separated from the human world. This results in the idea that space, where they can coexist, needs to be separately created. Instead of nature being considered as a subject impacting people and technology, it is considered an object whose parts can be used effectively and moved to “green” the urban space.

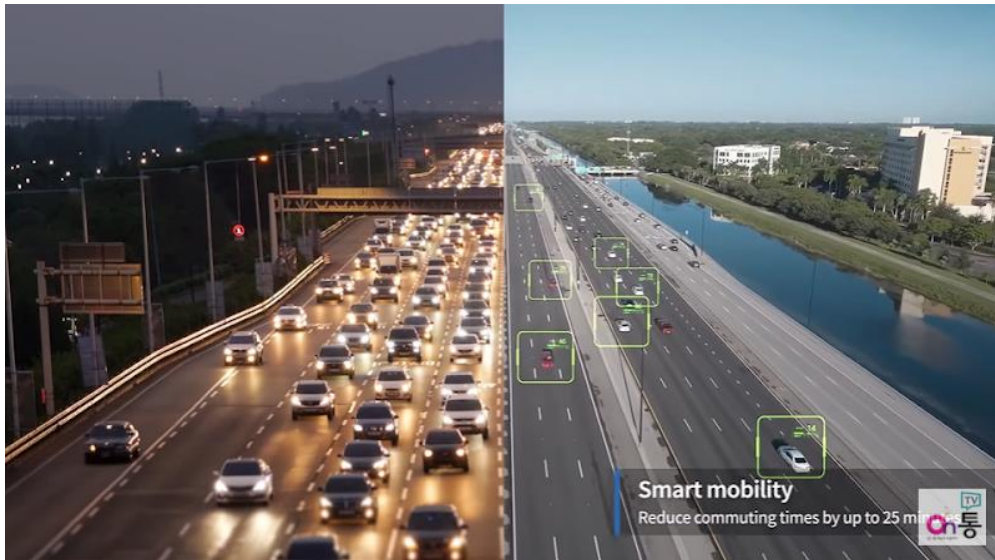


Image 8. The transformation to smart mobility.

As acknowledged previously, though nature is described as one of the actors in creating smart harmony, it ends up playing a role of an object that is used to achieve smart harmony. Behaviors that could disrupt harmony, that create some kind of chaos, are not allowed in this discourse. Harmony can be understood not only as peaceful and balanced existence but also as a romanticized word for *order*. The notion of the need to create a new space for harmony implies that already existing cities are lacking something in this aspect. Compared to smart cities, traditional cities in Korea lack order in urban space. There is a lot of traffic and people, trash on the streets, stray cats, street vendors, protests, and flooding. The smart city is imagined as a new type of urban space that has order. Imagery of clean streets, spacious driveways, green parks, and extensive safety and disaster prevention systems enforce this idea of smart harmony as order (example in image 8).

6 Discussion and conclusions

The purpose of this research was to explore how the concept of smartness is used in audiovisual place branding, specifically in branding smart cities. The main research question was: *What kind of meanings are given to the concept of 'smart' in Busan Eco-Delta smart city's audiovisual branding?* The main research question was accompanied by a question of *how these meanings create inclusion or exclusion of certain types of actors, behavior, and knowledge within discourses*. These questions

were explored by analyzing a promotional video presenting the Busan Eco-Delta Smart City project, a smart city project that is currently being built in the Southern city of Busan, South Korea. The video was analyzed by combining critical discourse studies with elements of critical visual studies. Specific analysis methods used in the analysis were power analysis focused on the power relationships within discourses, as well as iconographic analysis.

Through the analysis, three different discourses were constructed. These discourses were named smart comfort, smart growth, and smart harmony. All of these discourses view smartness and smart technology as something that will create positive change in urban living, whether by improving the lives of individuals, enhancing the growth of the national economy and international recognition or by recreating urban space in a harmonious and orderly way. By comparing these meanings of smartness to the six-piece smart city model introduced in the theory section of this paper, four of the pieces can be identified from the branding video: *smart economy*, *smart mobility*, *smart environment*, and *smart living*. The pieces that are lacking are *smart people* and *smart governance*. According to Griffiender et al's (2007) model, a smart city needs smart people, referring to active citizens who are interested in participating in city affairs together with smart governance that provides ways of participating. In the promotional video however, the citizens are presented rather as consumers or local implementors of national goals than active citizens. Other researchers also emphasize active citizen participation and citizen's rights as a crucial part of creating a successful smart city, which is made *by* the people rather than *for* the people (eg., Cardullo 2019; Townsend 2013; Hollands 2008). The dangers of creating exclusive urban enclaves where there is no room for contradictory views have been witnessed before in Korea's urban development history. For example, the development of the Gangnam district in Seoul and the first newly built smart city of Songdo in Incheon have been criticized for their exclusive and commodified nature. (Doucette & Pak, chapter 7; Mullins 2017.) Unfortunately, Busan Eco Delta Smart City shares similar aspects of exclusion that these two projects have: the lack of citizen participation, the emphasis on internationality and the ideal business environment, and the ignorance of the surrounding eco-system and communities that are negatively impacted by the project. As the previously completed urban development projects of Gangnam and Songdo have demonstrated, urban image construction has very real effects on the

recreating the material and social imagery of the urban space where certain actors, actions, and ideas are valued while others are rejected as less creative or not educated and modern enough (Broudehoux 2017, xxi).

Considering the three discourses from the context of Korean society and the regimes of truth that exists in it, the discourses support the developmentalist view of the smart city as a transformed urban space that is comfortable, orderly and supports the constant development of the national economy and brand. Typical place branding strategies of simplifying messages, repeating values and visual imagery, and emphasizing the uniqueness of place are used to create a strong and positive brand for the city even before it exists. Smart city, like any other urban development strategy, should not be considered a neutral or apolitical concept, but rather a strategy that aims at creating an urban space characterized by consensus, order, and efficiency. This strategy reproduces the desires of the most powerful actors while excluding those who do not fit into these ideals. However, a smart city strategy is not the only way to imagine the future of cities. There are other city models that have not received as much attention, like the slow city, just city, or the garden city, that emphasize more participatory planning and branding approaches and have more precise criteria that the city needs to meet to have the right to hold a certain title. The reason the smart city has become such an overpowering strategy in urban development over these alternative approaches may just lay in its blurry definition – a smart city can be shaped into whatever form suits the creator's agenda.

The results of this thesis are based on the analysis of one promotional video. Due to the small research sample, it cannot be assumed that the results can be directly generalized to describe other smart cities in Korea or other parts of the world. Using a more expansive material and including different materials (e.g., project plan) in the analysis would have enabled the comparison and the discovery of similarities and differences between promotional videos of different actors. On the other hand, it is not uncommon to choose a smaller research material in critical discourse studies, as it enables detailed analysis of visual and verbal strategies, revealing, for example, hidden power relations within or between discourses. It is also worth noting that critical discourse research is, as the name implies, critical and usually focuses on bringing up social injustices and changing them. When carrying out the analysis, the re-

searcher sets out to create their own kind of selective narrative, which is equally influenced by their research interests and ideologies. Therefore, if the goal would be to produce generalizable, easily repeatable, and purely objective analysis, other methods should be considered. In the end, the combination of critical discourse studies with critical visual studies suited the examination of a branding video, where linguistic and visual rhetoric creates certain kinds of representations of reality, reinforcing certain kinds of discourses.

As discussed earlier, critical discourse analysis does not only focus on criticizing but also on producing alternative ways of imagining the future. To continue critical social research on smart cities, the suggestion for future research is to examine smart city strategy by comparing its relationship with other urban development models, like *slow cities* or *just cities* (e.g., Pink 2008; Fainstein 2014). These models all share a similar goal of advancing urban life, but their ways of achieving this goal are different. Comparing these approaches could help at balancing the urban development discussion, which is currently heavily dominated by smart cities. Critical discourse analysis is also interested in the transformative nature of power resistance against dominant discourses. In the case of Busan Eco Delta Smart City, the reactions of the local residents could be researched to bring forth the complexity of urban identity and facilitate participatory place branding methods for a more just and inclusive urban development.

Rapidly changing urban imaginaries have real effects on the urban space, creating social exclusion and reproducing power hierarchies between stakeholders. Korea is not the only country that uses persuasive place branding techniques to promote the smart city. As the writer of this thesis is Finnish, it is relevant to point out that smart city projects are actively promoted in Finland with many similar place branding techniques found in the Korean smart city. The critical evaluation of internationally circulating urban strategies and their suitability to the local context may often be forgotten especially in countries like Finland that are known for their social democratic governance, extensive public relations, and high value of nature. Despite these positive qualities, no country is beyond the influence of the global “place wars” that the smart city is currently dominating. The ethical considerations and risks of exclusive language are aspects of place branding that smart city planners from all over the world

should consider if they wish to create a true “harmony of technology, people, and nature”.

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